

L E S S O N 24

Every Believer Has a Role to Play

10: Stewardship and Service

Scripture Focus: 1 Peter 4:10 · Romans 12:4-8

This lesson continues stewardship and service by focusing on the believer's place in the body of Christ and the work God gives His people to do.

BY THE END

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to 1 Peter 4:10 and Romans 12:4-8.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

V O C A B U L A R Y

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Faith	Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.
Service	Using God's gifts for His glory and the good of others, especially in the life of the church.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Stewardship	Faithful management of what God owns and entrusts, including time, money, gifts, work, and opportunities.
Salvation	God's gracious rescue of sinners through the finished work of Christ, received by faith rather than earned by works.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see service in the body of Christ from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The teaching continues stewardship and service by focusing on the believer's place in the body of Christ and the work God gives His people to do.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

1 Peter 4:10 and Romans 12:4-8 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. You are serving the Lord Jesus Christ. And we saw that verse earlier, but I want to emphasize that idea of the reward that we receive.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. When every member is doing their part, the church grows in unity, maturity, and love. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

1 Peter 4:10

1 Peter 4:10 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read 1 Peter 4:10 first, then read Romans 12:4-8. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

You are serving the Lord Jesus Christ. And we saw that verse earlier, but I want to emphasize that idea of the reward that we receive.

Study the passage:

- 1.** *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
 - 2.** *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
 - 3.** *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*
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FRAMEWORK

Stewardship Under God's Ownership

FAITHFUL STEWARDSHIP	SELF-OWNERSHIP
Everything belongs to God.	My time, money, and gifts exist mainly for me.
Service flows from gratitude and calling.	Service is optional unless convenient.
Faithfulness is measured before the Lord.	Worth is measured by visibility or applause.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does service in the body of Christ most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. There's another judgment in the future called the great white throne judgment, and that's where unbelievers are judged for the sins that they've done. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. Our motivation should be to serve Christ, not to impress people or gain recognition. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The

question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Service in the body of Christ belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. The most effective service in the church comes from a heart that is humble, grateful, and eager to build others up. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **service in the body of Christ should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **Are you faithfully using the abilities God has given to you?**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about service in the body of christ?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about service in the body of christ. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use 1 Peter 4:10 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
